

# Printable Skat rules

## Cards and card points

Three players, **32 cards** (♣ ♠ ♥ ♦, each 7 to Ace). Everyone gets ten cards; two lie face down in the middle as the **skat**. The deck holds **120 card points**:

| Card | Card points |
|------|-------------|
| A    | 11          |
| 10   | 10          |
| K    | 4           |
| Q    | 3           |
| J    | 2           |
| 7    | 0           |
| 8    | 0           |
| 9    | 0           |

## Trumps and following suit

The four **Jacks** are always the highest trumps: ♣J, ♠J, ♥J, ♦J. In a suit game the trump suit follows with A, 10, K, Q, 9, 8, 7 – eleven trumps. In Grand only the Jacks are trumps.

Side suits run A, 10, K, Q, 9, 8, 7. Null has no trumps, and every suit runs A, K, Q, J, 10, 9, 8, 7.

You must **follow** the suit led; trumps count as one suit, so a Jack follows trumps. If you cannot follow, you may trump or throw off. The highest trump wins the trick, otherwise the highest card of the suit led.

## Bidding

Forehand sits on the dealer's left, then middlehand; the dealer is rearhand. **Middlehand bids to forehand** ("yes" or "pass"), then **rearhand bids to the winner**. Whoever is left is the declarer, and their game must reach the last bid. If all pass, the cards are dealt again. Only these values may be bid:

**Every value you can bid, from the lowest up**

18, 20, 22, 23, 24, 27, 30, 33, 35, 36, 40, 44, 45, 46, 48, 50, 54, 55, 59, 60, 63, 66, 70, 72, 77, 80, 81, 84, 88, 90, 96, 99, 100, 108, 110, 117, 120, 121, 126, 130, 132, 135, 140, 143, 144, 150, 153, 154, 156, 160, 162, 165, 168, 170, 176, 180, 187, 192, 198, 204, 216, 240, 264

# The skat: pick up and discard, or Hand

The declarer **picks up the skat** and **discards** any two cards face down; their points count for the declarer. Or they play **Hand** and leave the skat untouched – one level more, and only then may they announce Schneider or Schwarz. A suit game or Grand Ouvert is Hand only too; Null Ouvert may also follow a pick-up. Then they name the game. Forehand leads.

## Games and game value

**Game value** = **base value** × **multiplier**. The multiplier is: matadors **with** or **without** so many (from ♣J down, counted over hand and skat) + 1 for **game** + 1 each for **Hand**, **Schneider**, **Schneider announced**, **Schwarz**, **Schwarz announced** and **Ouvert**. The base values:

| Game       | Base value |
|------------|------------|
| Diamonds ♦ | 9          |
| Hearts ♥   | 10         |
| Spades ♠   | 11         |
| Clubs ♣    | 12         |
| Grand      | 24         |

**Null** is not multiplied: the declarer must take no trick, at fixed values:

| Game             | Value |
|------------------|-------|
| Null             | 23    |
| Null Hand        | 35    |
| Null Ouvert      | 46    |
| Null Ouvert Hand | 59    |

## Winning and scoring

The declarer needs **61 card points** (skat included); 60 each is a loss. **Schneider**: one side has 30 points or fewer. **Schwarz**: one side takes no trick.

Won: + **game value**. Lost: – 2 × **game value**. The defenders score nothing.

**Overbid**: if the game is worth less than the bid, it is lost and scored at the lowest multiple of the base value that reaches the bid.